THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 23: **The Ball Poem (First Flight Poem)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** general reflection on loss	Universal.
2	**(a)** respect for the boy's privacy	He stays away.
3	**(b)** The ball was lost by the boy.	Past passive.
4	**(a)** the boy needs to grieve	Real loss.
5	**(c)** a boy staring at water	Core image.
6	**(a)** silently	Modifies verb.
7	**(a)** intense emotion	Deep sorrow.
8	**(a)** learning to stand up after loss	Message.
9	**(b)** comfort	To comfort.
10	**(d)** responsibility	A lesson.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	To show a happy start (1) so that the loss seems more painful by contrast (1).	1+1
12	He respects the boy's grief (1) and knows the boy must learn alone (1).	1+1
13	To face loss bravely (1) and move on (1).	1+1
14	They show the poet's concern (1) and the boy's helplessness (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	The ball is merry (1). The boy then stands in sorrow (1). The sudden change shows how fragile joy is (1).	1+1+1
16	Society values owning things (1). The boy realises things can vanish (1). He must learn detachment (1).	1+1+1
17	The poet said that money could not buy back his grief (1). 'Cannot' becomes 'could not' (1). Pronoun changes (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Money would be a quick fix (1). It would disrespect real grief (1). It would deny the boy's lesson (1).	1+1+1
18	They mean well (1). They underestimate his grief (1). The poet disagrees (1).	1+1+1
	OR: After the boy lost his ball, he stood by the water (1). 'After' shows sequence (1). Complex sentence (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Event (1). Boy's grief (1). Poet's reflection (1). Money (1). Growth (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Greeting (1). Poem (1). Materialism (1). Values (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1
20	Sympathetic (1). Refuses easy comfort (1). Respects grief (1). Sees growth (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Narration (1). Description (1). Question (1). Reflection (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Writing that the ball is the main subject; it is a **symbol of loss** and the poem is about learning to cope with loss.
- Saying the poet will buy him another ball and all will be well; the poet says that **money cannot replace** the feeling of loss.
- Missing the idea: the boy begins to understand **responsibility** in a world of possessions where things get lost.
- Giving the wrong setting: the ball rolls down the steps and into the **harbour**, where it is lost for good.
- Mixing the poet: **John Berryman**, an American poet; the poem is in blank (unrhymed) verse with *enjambment*.
- Spelling slips: *responsibility, harbour, possession, loss, ball poem*.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 23: **The Ball Poem (First Flight Poem)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** coming of age through loss	Theme.
2	**(d)** things one owns	Belongings.
3	**(a)** he realises that he must care for things	First awareness.
4	**(c)** reflective lyric	Reflective.
5	**(a)** What is he to do?	No answer needed.
6	**(c)** does not trivialise the boy's pain	Respect.
7	**(d)** stress the boy's helplessness	Emphasis.
8	**(d)** joyful bounce leading to grief	Contrast.
9	**(c)** loss is a part of life	Message.
10	**(c)** show the poet's concern and urgency	Anxiety.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	It stands for childhood and cherished things (1) and its loss for early disillusionment (1).	1+1
12	It uses plain words (1) and refuses easy consolation (1).	1+1
13	It belongs to the outside world (1) and cannot touch inner grief (1).	1+1
14	The harbour makes retrieval impossible (1) and symbolises vast, uncontrollable forces (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	The boy is shaken (1). He senses responsibility (1). He learns to stand up (1).	1+1+1
16	Light and simple at first (1). Serious in the middle (1). Philosophical at the end (1).	1+1+1
17	She tried to console him (1). He felt a new responsibility (1). Both used correctly (1).	1+1+1
	OR: It makes the poet an eyewitness (1). It gives personal sympathy (1). It lets readers share the vision (1).	1+1+1
18	The boy is 'what is he now' (1). His situation echoes ours (1). The poem ends with universal truth (1).	1+1+1
	OR: grief (1). loss (1). possession (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Theme (1). Imagery (1). Tone (1). Language (1). Evaluation (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Format (1). Memory (1). Gratitude (1). Lesson (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1
20	Both about loss (1). Ball: small loss, growing up (1). Sermon: death (1). Both teach acceptance (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Ball (1). Water (1). Boy (1). Money (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1

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- Missing the idea: the boy begins to understand **responsibility** in a world of possessions where things get lost.
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- Spelling slips: *responsibility, harbour, possession, loss, ball poem*.

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 23: **The Ball Poem (First Flight Poem)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** Real loss cannot be repaired by replacement.	Poet's message.
2	**(c)** critical of its power to console	External to grief.
3	**(b)** express universal truth	Universalise.
4	**(a)** make us reflect on loss and growth	Purpose.
5	**(b)** playful to sorrowful and reflective	Mood shift.
6	**(b)** money cannot ease deep grief	Meaning.
7	**(c)** plain but emotionally rich	Style.
8	**(a)** a happy beginning that contrasts with loss	Contrast.
9	**(d)** He said that the ball was lost.	Backshift.
10	**(b)** Learning to Stand Up	Theme.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	For the child it is major (1) and prepares him for adult loss (1).	1+1
12	Losing things teaches care (1) and responsibility in a world of possessions (1).	1+1
13	The first narrates an event (1) and the second reflects on its meaning (1).	1+1
14	It involves pain (1) and acceptance of what cannot be recovered (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	It is deep and wide (1). The ball is irretrievable (1). It suggests the vastness of life's losses (1).	1+1+1
16	The boy staring (1). The water (1). The silent poet (1).	1+1+1
17	It means to mourn what cannot be undone (1). The boy may do so now (1). The poem says he must move on with strength (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Loss is inevitable (1). Possessions are temporary (1). Strength comes from acceptance (1).	1+1+1
18	It marks a step into maturity (1). The boy learns responsibility (1). Loss shapes him (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Listen (1). Do not belittle (1). Teach resilience (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Intro (1). Poem (1). Examples (1). Benefits (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Format (1). Greeting (1). Discussion (1). Advice (1). End (1).	2+2+1
20	Setting (1). Child (1). Loss (1). Reaction (1). Learning (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Plain language (1). Silence (1). Restraint (1). Reflection (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1

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